

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner for cloud-native collaboration products.*

Positioning, ten years of end-to-end product ownership in SaaS, data platforms, and regulated environments – brought to bear on Office and Cloud Storage at STRATO.

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Dear STRATO hiring team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role on Office and Cloud Storage. I have spent the past ten years delivering product end-to-end in environments that are technically complex, stakeholder-heavy, and intolerant of vague requirements: a defence-scale AI data platform at Rohde and Schwarz, a public labour market analytics product at the Federal Employment Agency, an InsurTech SaaS platform at Emil Group, and a mobile healthcare application at CLINET Platforms. What those roles share is the pattern your job description describes: own the roadmap, manage the backlog, close the loop from discovery to KPI measurement, and hold the thread across engineering, business, and management.

The Nextcloud context is one I find technically honest. I understand open-source ecosystems from the infrastructure side – I have run Kubernetes clusters, managed GitOps rollouts with ArgoCD, and worked with REST API integrations as the product layer on top of complex backend systems. I have not managed a Nextcloud-specific product before, and I name that clearly. What I bring is the systems fluency to get productive quickly and the discipline to prioritise learning the domain-specific nuances in the first two weeks rather than pretending they do not exist.

The AI-native workflow requirement resonates with how I already operate. At Rohde and Schwarz I used LLM-assisted development to independently deliver in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year. In my own projects I have built agentic workflow frameworks using file-queue-based agent loops, n8n automations, and Lovable for rapid prototype generation. I treat these tools as execution infrastructure, not novelty: the goal is to make hypotheses tangible faster, which is exactly the framing in your posting.

During my time at Emil Group I inherited a situation where a 17-person team had lost sprint discipline, client trust was eroding, and senior developers were leaving. I split the team, reintroduced velocity tracking, ran weekly product workshops with clients, and reduced attrition from near-total to a single departure. That experience taught me that the hard part of product

ownership is not writing user stories – it is rebuilding confidence across stakeholders who have been let down, and doing so through delivery rather than promises. I would bring the same clarity-through-structure approach to the cross-site collaboration between Berlin and Karlsruhe.

I am based in Berlin, hold German citizenship, and am available within four weeks. I would be glad to talk through how my background maps to the specific product challenges you are working on.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
